

Steak Around the World

Buenos Aires leads the world in the preparation of succulent, tender beefsteaks. But global travelers can enjoy great steaks at several other cities that lie close to lush, free-grazing grasslands and pride themselves on their beef-eating cultures.

BUENOS AIRES

Manolo inexpensive

Bolivar 1299, San Telmo;
www.restaurantmanolo.com.ar

Local Argentinians love this old-fashioned, cafeteria-style *parrilla* (restaurant serving grilled meats) for its delicious delicacies, which are incredible bargains. Chitterlings and sweetbreads, textured like melted butter and sprinkled with lemon juice, precede tender grilled steaks. Service is fast, the ambience loud, and walls feature soccer-themed memorabilia.

El Obrero moderate

Agustín R. Caffarena 64, La Boca; +54 11 4362 9912
U2's Bono, Francis Ford Coppola, and Robert Duvall are three celebrities that have been drawn to dine at this atmospheric steakhouse in the colorful La Boca portside district. It opened in 1954 and continues to serve some of the best, and biggest, steaks in town. Choose from the *parrilla* specials on the chalkboard and aim to arrive before the busiest time of 9:00 PM.

La Cabrera moderate

Cabrera 5099, Palermo Viejo;
www.parrillalacabrera.com.ar

A romantic steakhouse in one of the city's prettiest districts, La Cabrera comprises twin dining salons of mosaic flooring, timber furnishings, and stripped-bare walls. Its beefsteaks are huge and first-rate, and they come with around 12 side dishes, from Béarnaise sauce to roasted artichokes and mashed squash with raisins. Tables are candlelit; outdoor tables overlook a cobbled street.

Cabaña Las Lilas expensive

Alicia Moreau de Justo 516; www.lasilas.com
Situated on the waterfront in the Puerto Madero docklands district, this exclusive *parrilla* serves steaks from its own ranches. Ask for the superior rib-eye cut and accompany it with one of the 700 premium Argentinian wines offered.

MENDOZA, ARGENTINA

At restaurants in Argentina's wine capital, Mendoza, world-class red wines accompany Argentinian beefsteaks. Choose a downtown *parrilla* or dine at a wine estate, where vistas of vineyards and the snow-capped Andes form the backdrop to premium wines and prime beef.

Don Mario inexpensive

25 de Mayo 1324, Dorrego; www.donmario.com.ar
At this basic *parrilla*, Don Mario allows his cooking to do the talking. The sweetbreads are outstanding and the sirloin and tenderloin steaks are fit for gauchos. The mixed grill option of combined delicacies and beef cuts is excellent and economical.

Ocho Cepas moderate

Peru 1192; www.ochocepas.com
Ocho Cepas is a wine-and-gourmet-grill experience set within a beautifully refurbished colonial house, run by Argentine chef Max Casa. Choose alfresco dining beneath the Mendoza stars or opt for an intimate interior table amid colonial arches. Meat and wine options are both outstanding.

Cavas Wine Lodge expensive

Costaflares S/N; www.cavaswinelodge.com
This romantic restaurant is set in a luxury wine lodge and spa, situated within a 35-acre (14-hectare) vineyard. It emphasizes regional Mendoza cuisine, from appetizers such as goat cheese terrine with "wine caviar" to rib-eye steak with *chimichurri* – the spicy pesto-like sauce of choice for *asados*.

MONTEVIDEO, URUGUAY

Uruguay has the highest number of meat-eaters per capita in the world, outshining even its close neighbor, Argentina. Steakhouses in its capital city, Montevideo, overlook the Atlantic Ocean and serve classic beef cuts oozing with juices and flavors.

La Casa Violeta moderate

Rambla Armenia 3667; www.lacasavioleta.com
Choose a terrace table at gorgeous Violeta, which faces one of Montevideo's prettiest harbors. There are seven kinds of steak, from rib-eye and porterhouse to the restaurant's rib-chop specialty, and the fantastic meats are whisked to tables on long skewers in the local style.

